[METRIC]
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SUPERSEDES
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPONGES, SYNTHETIC AND REGENERATED CELLULOSE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE This description covers sponges made of synthetic plastic or regenerated cellulose.

2. CLASSIFICATION Sponges covered by this CID shall conform to the following types, styles, and classes:

Type I - Synthetic plastic
Type II - Regenerated cellulose

Style A - Course pores
Style B - Fine pores

Class 1 - Uncompressed
Class 2 - Compressed

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Material. In addition to the material requirements below, the sponges shall include such compounding ingredients as necessary to produce a soft pliable sponge when wet.

3.1.1 Type I, plastic sponges. The plastic sponge shall be made of a polymerized synthetic resin. The material shall be that normally used for sponges, shall be soft and pliable, and shall resist any degradation when exposed to normal household cleaning products. The type I sponges shall have an absorption of 1500% minimum. The percentage absorption shall be determined when tested and calculated as described by 3.1.3

3.1.2 Type II, cellulose sponges. The cellulose sponge shall be made of regenerated cellulose. The sponge shall be soft and pliable, and shall resist any degradation when exposed to normal household cleaning products. The type II sponges shall have an absorption of 2000% minimum. The percentage absorption shall be determined when tested and calculated as described by 3.1.3.

3.1.3 Absorption. The absorption of the sponges shall be determined as follows: The sample sponge be washed free of contaminants by a minimum of 5 cycles of being immersed in distilled water and hand squeezed as dry as possible. [Conditioning of the samples at 72±2°C and 50±4% relative humidity for 24 hours shall be required only in instance of dispute of absorption compliance.] The samples shall be weighed to the nearest 10 mg, this value shall be designated W1. The samples shall then be immersed in distilled water and squeezed until all the air has been expelled. Using a non-squeezing hanging device, remove the sponge from the water and allow to drain for 30 seconds. Place on tared holder and reweigh, this value shall be designated W2. Calculate the percent absorption as follows:

$$\text{Percent absorption} = [(W2-W1)/W1] \times 100$$

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor Street, Fort Worth, TX 76102

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FSC 7920

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3.1.4 Hot water resistance. Submersion in boiling water for 2 hours shall not change the feel, flexibility, or color of the sponge.

3.1.5 Tensile strength. The type I plastic sponges shall have a tensile strength of 3.4 N/cm^2 minimum for both length and width. The type II regenerated cellulose sponges shall have tensile strength of 17.2 N/cm^2 minimum. The test shall only be performed on uncut sponge batches. The sample(s) to be tested shall be thoroughly wetted and hand squeezed as dry as possible. Samples shall be cut 5 cm wide, 5 cm long, and 2.5 cm thick. The tensile strength shall be determined by Method 5100 of FED-STD-191, except that the distance between the jaws shall be 2.54 cm. The breaking force in newtons divided by the cross-section area in square centimeters equals the tensile strength in N/cm^2.

3.2 Styles. Style A sponges shall have pores which average 2.4 mm to 19.1 mm in diameter. Style B sponges shall have pores which average 2.3 mm or less in diameter. The average diameter shall be measured by randomly selecting a bounded area on the surface of the sponge, such as a box 3 cm by 3 cm drawn on the surface of the sponge. The whole pores within the box shall be counted and measured, and the average diameter calculated.

3.3 Classes. Sponges shall be class 1 uncompressed, or class 2 compressed. When Class 2 sponges are specified, the sponge shall be dry and the thickness of the sponge after compression shall be not more than 20 percent of it's thickness when wetted.

3.4 Sizes. The sponges shall be supplied in the sizes specified in the contract or purchase order. Unless otherwise specified by the contract or purchase order the dimensions specified for the length and widths shall be minimums, the tolerance for the specified thickness shall be -0 and +0.5 cm.

3.5 Color. When a color is specified, the color shall be a commonly accepted shade for that color. When no color is specified, the color shall be at the option of the contractor, and may be a commercial pack of mixed colors. The color of the sponge shall not bleed when exposed to boiling water for 5 minutes.

3.6 Workmanship. Sponges shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this commercial item description. Sponges shall contain no ingredient which may be harmful to the skin. Sponges shall be free from defects which may affect their durability, serviceability and appearance. The sponges shall be soft and pliable when wet, sent free, uniform in color, and ready to use without further preparation.

3.7 Regulatory Requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraphs 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

3.8 Commercial item. The use of the term "commercial item" in this document does not imply that any item or items offered are not required to conform with all requirements specified herein.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, shall conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and shall be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

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6. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING

6.1 Packaging, packing and marking. The packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Intended use. Sponges described by this CID are intended for general cleaning use in kitchens, bathrooms, etc.

7.2 Ordering data. Purchases should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. Type, style and class.
c. Size
d. Color, if applicable.
e. The packaging, packing and marking desired

7.3 Part Identification Number (PIN). This part numbering system is intended for identification and cross-indexing of the item by the government only and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

Example: AA2073-2A1-Coral-14.6x9.2x4.4

- Size
- Color
- Class - 1 = Uncompressed; 2 = Compressed
- Style - A = Style A; B = Style B
- Type - 1 = Type I; 2 = Type II

CID A-A-2073

7.4 National Stock Numbers. The following NSNs (with the appropriate part number) are known to use this document:

NSN	Part Number	Size (LxWxTh, cm)
7920-00-161-6219	AA2073-2A2-Natural	5.7(dia)x3.4
7920-00-240-2555	AA2073-2B2-Natural	14.6x9.2x4.4
7920-00-240-2559	AA2073-2A2-Unspecified	14.6x9.2x4.4
7920-00-559-8462	AA2073-2A1-Coral	14.6x9.2x4.4
7920-00-559-8463	AA2073-2A1-Green	14.6x9.2x4.4
7920-00-559-8464	AA2073-2A1-Yellow	14.6x9.2x4.4
7920-00-633-9905	AA2073-2B1-Natural	11.1x6.9x2.2
7920-00-633-9906	AA2073-2B1-Natural	15.8x10.7x5.4
7920-00-633-9908	AA2073-1B1-Natural	14.6x10.7x3.8
7920-00-633-9911	AA2073-1B1-Natural	14.9x11.1x4.1
7920-00-633-9915	AA2073-1B1-Natural	17.7x11.1x5.7
7920-00-633-9928	AA2073-2A1-Natural	11.1x7.0x2.2
7920-00-685-4152	AA2073-1B1-Natural	18.7x11.1x3.8
7920-00-782-3778	AA2073-2A1-Unspecified	20.3x17.7x0.6
7920-00-884-1115	AA2073-2A1-Natural	15.8x10.7x5.4
7920-00-884-1116	AA2073-2A1-Natural	14.6x9.2x4.4
7920-00-926-5313	AA2073-2B1-Unspecified	20.3x18.4x0.8
7920-01-383-7936	AA2073-2A2-Olive Drab	14.6x9.2x4.4

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